

Riverdale Park, MD

Public Information Reference for the AI-Assisted Code Enforcement Project
Compiled by Group 1 | INST 623, Spring 2026 | University of Maryland

1. Town Overview

Understanding the basic structure and demographics of Riverdale Park is essential context for evaluating the fairness and scope of the AI code enforcement system.

Official Name	Town of Riverdale Park, Maryland
County	Prince George's County, MD
Incorporated	1920 (Chapter 731, Acts of 1920)
Population (2020 Census)	7,351 residents
Ward Structure	6 Wards — each represented by an elected Council member
Current Mayor	Ifiok C. Inyang (2-year term, expires 2027)
Town Address	5008 Queensbury Road, Riverdale Park, MD 20737
Phone	(301) 927-6381
Office Hours	Monday – Friday, 8:30 a.m. to 5:00 p.m.

Source: <https://msa.maryland.gov/msa/mdmanual/37mun/riverdale/html/r.html>

The 6-Ward geographic structure is directly relevant to the project's neighborhood-level fairness analysis (Task #5). Disaggregated model performance metrics should be evaluated against Ward boundaries where address metadata is available.

2. Development Services & Code Enforcement

2.1 Office of Development Services

The Office of Development Services (ODS) is the town department responsible for code enforcement, permits, and rental licensing — the direct operational context for this project. Ryan Chelton serves as Director of Development Services.

Department	Office of Development Services
Key Functions	Issues permits and licenses; conducts rental inspections; enforces Town Code property standards
Permits Issued	Building , Dumpster/Container , Special Events , Utility Permits
Licenses Issued	Business License , Rental License (Single & Multi-Family) , Mobile Vendor License

Source: https://www.riverdaleparkmd.gov/our_town/development_services/index.php

2.2 Rental License & Inspection Program

The rental licensing system is the primary data source for this project. Riverdale Park administers its own rental licenses independently of Prince George's County — meaning the Town, not the County, controls the inspection records and photographs.

Jurisdiction	Riverdale Park manages its own rental licenses — NOT under Prince George's County DPIE jurisdiction
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License Types	Single-Family Rental License and Multi-Family Rental License
Inspection Process	After application, a temporary license is issued for 30-90 days while an area inspector performs an on-site inspection
Violation Handling	Violations found during inspection result in written notice to property owner with a compliance timeframe, followed by a re-inspection
Data Relevance	Inspection photographs taken during rental licensing are the primary dataset for the AI classification model
Privacy Note	Some inspection photos may include interior images from rental licensing — these must be excluded from the dataset per PII/privacy requirements

Source: <https://www.riverdaleparkmd.gov/our-town/development-services/permits-and-licenses/index.php>

3. Town Code Structure

The Town Code is the legal framework that defines all violation categories. The project team needs to map these codes to identify which are visually distinguishable from photographs (Task #1).

3.1 Code Chapters Most Relevant to the Project

Chapter	Title	Relevance to Project
Ch. 55	Rental License and Inspections	Directly governs the inspection process that generates the project's photo dataset
Ch. 56	Board of Code Appeals	Appeals process — relevant for understanding enforcement outcomes the AI assists
Ch. 63	Vacant Property Registration	Potential violation category identifiable from exterior photographs
Ch. 66	Walls, Fences and Hedges	Visually inspectable — fence/hedge condition is a strong candidate for image classification
Ch. 67	Property Maintenance	Core chapter for exterior property standards — highest relevance to photo-based classification
Ch. 68	Vehicles - Permit Parking	Vehicles parked on unimproved surfaces — potentially identifiable from photographs

Source: https://www.riverdaleparkmd.gov/government/ordinance_code_sample.php

4. Common Violations — Official List

Riverdale Park's Development Services office publishes an official list of the most frequent property standards violations. These are the highest-priority categories for the AI model's initial training scope, as they represent both high frequency and visual identifiability from photographs.

#	Violation Type	Description	Visual Identifiability
1	Overgrown Grass & Weeds	Grass/weeds exceeding 10 inches in height; harbors rodents and pests	High — directly measurable visual feature from exterior photos

2	Open Storage of Garbage & Rubbish	Accumulation of garbage or rubbish in property areas; fire, pest, and nuisance hazard	High — visible clutter/debris in yard or exterior areas
3	Chipping, Peeling & Flaking Paint	Deteriorated paint on surfaces; lead paint risk for pre-1978 homes	Medium-High — visible on exterior walls and trim
4	Damaged Accessory Structures	Fences, garages, retaining walls, sheds in disrepair; diminishes property value	Medium — structural damage may require close-range photos
5	Missing Address Numbers	House number absent, illegible, or non-compliant (min. 4-inch height, contrasting color)	Medium — readable in close or direct-angle photographs

Source:

https://www.riverdaleparkmd.gov/our_town/development_services/neighborhood_improvement_literature/educational_material/_common_violations.php

Note: The Town Code (Chapters 67 and 68) and the International Property Maintenance Code (2015) are the legal sources for the above violations. The project should confirm with Ryan Chelton whether these 5 categories are among the top 20-30 most frequent in the labeled dataset.

5. Legal & Privacy Framework

The following legal and regulatory context is critical for the data access and sharing protocols the team must establish with Ryan Chelton and the Town's IT department (Task #2).

5.1 Rental License Jurisdiction

Riverdale Park is explicitly listed as a municipality that operates its own rental licensing system, separate from Prince George's County. This means:

- All inspection photographs and rental license records are held by the Town of Riverdale Park directly
- Data access negotiations must go through Ryan Chelton and the Town's IT department — not the County's DPIE
- The team cannot use County-level data sharing agreements; a Town-specific protocol is required

Source:

<https://www.princegeorgescountymd.gov/departments-offices/permitting-inspections-and-enforcement/licensing/rental-housing-licenses/single-family-rental-licensing>

5.2 Town Charter — Enforcement Authority

The Town Charter explicitly grants Riverdale Park authority to establish and enforce a housing and habitability code, and to issue licenses and regulate rental properties. This is the legal foundation for Ryan Chelton's role and the project's data source.

- The Town has authority to "establish a housing or habitability code and provide for the enforcement" of same

- The Town regulates licensing of businesses and rental properties within its corporate limits
- Any data sharing with the University must be consistent with this charter and applicable state law

Source: <https://mgaleg.maryland.gov/Pubs/LegisLegal/Muni-Charters/2019-municipal-charter-riverdale-park.pdf>

5.3 Implications for the Project's Data Governance Task

Based on the above, the team's data-sharing framework task (T-new) should address the following minimum requirements:

- Confirm that only exterior inspection photographs are shared — interior rental photos must be excluded
- Ensure no PII is included: no house numbers, no license plates, no identifiable residents
- Establish whether access will be on-site (preferred) or via a university-managed secure server
- Document the arrangement in writing with the Town before any data transfer occurs
- Reference applicable Maryland privacy law and the Freedom of Information Act in the agreement

6. Fairness & Neighborhood Context

The project includes a neighborhood-level fairness analysis (Task #5). The following public information provides the geographic framework needed for that analysis.

Ward Count	6 Wards — each is a distinct geographic and political unit
Ward Map	2023 Ward Boundary Map available as public PDF from the Town website
Population	~7,351 (2020 Census); diverse community per the Police Department's public description
Fairness Risk	An AI enforcement system that is not carefully evaluated could systematically flag properties in certain wards at higher rates
Recommended Approach	Where address metadata is available, disaggregate model performance metrics (false positive rate, precision, recall) by Ward

Ward Boundary Map (PDF): [riverdaleparkmd.gov — 2023 Ward Boundary Map](https://www.riverdaleparkmd.gov/2023-Ward-Boundary-Map.pdf)

Source: <https://msa.maryland.gov/msa/mdmanual/37mun/riverdale/html/r.html>

7. Key Source Links Summary

The following table consolidates all public sources referenced in this document for quick access during project work.

Resource	URL
Common Violations (official list)	https://www.riverdaleparkmd.gov/our_town/development_services/neighborhood_improvement_literature/educational_material/_common_violations.php
Town Code (all chapters)	https://www.riverdaleparkmd.gov/government/ordinance_code_sample.php
Development Services Department	https://www.riverdaleparkmd.gov/our_town/development_services/index.php
Permits & Licenses	https://www.riverdaleparkmd.gov/our_town/development_services/permits_and_licenses/index.php
2023 Ward Boundary Map (PDF)	https://www.riverdaleparkmd.gov/2023-Ward-Boundary-Map.pdf
Town Charter (PDF)	https://mgaleg.maryland.gov/Pubs/LegisLegal/Muni-Charters/2019-municipal-charter-riverdale-park.pdf
Town Overview (MD State Archives)	https://msa.maryland.gov/msa/mdmanual/37mun/riverdale/html/r.html

Rental License Background (County)	https://www.princegeorgescountymd.gov/departments-offices/permitting-inspections-and-enforcement/licensing/rental-housing-licenses/single-family-rental-licensing
Neighborhood Improvement Guides	https://www.riverdaleparkmd.gov/our_town/development_services/neighborhood_improvement_literature/index.php
